Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

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Curricular Practical Training (CPT)

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What Is Curricular Practical Training?

Curricular Practical Training (CPT) is a type of work authorization that allows F-1 international students to participate in paid and unpaid off-campus academic internships and practicums during their degree program.

CPT may be authorized only when practical training is an integral and required part of an established curriculum, is directly related to the student's major area of study and is required for all students — regardless of citizenship — participating in that program.

CPT cannot be authorized solely to provide a ty. Optional internships and elective courses do not qual lum without participating in practical training, the trainin ance.

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Step 2: Complete the CPT I-20 Request

Step 3: Wait for Advisor's Approval

Step 4: Receive CPT Authorization

Step 5: Get a Social Security Number (If Applicable)

Step 6: Begin Work on CPT

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Curricular Practical Training Gu

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